

DMS System Security & Validation Reference

Internal technical reference for backend validation, frontend integration, sanitization, SQL safety, and exception handling.

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Scope: Backend validation, data sanitization, SQL injection protection, exception handling, and frontend integration - module by module.

Generated from backend/docs/SECURITY_AND_VALIDATION.md

DMS System Security & Validation Reference

1. Target behavior (all modules)

Every user-facing write operation should follow this pattern:

```

????????????????      ?????????????????????      ?????????????????????      ?????????????????
? Frontend  ?      ? Frontend      ?      ? Backend      ?      ? Backend      ?
? Validate  ? ??? ? Disable submit ? ??? ? Validate      ? ??? ? Sanitize + ?
? on change ?      ? when invalid  ?      ? in controller ?      ? parameterized?
????????????????      ?????????????????????      ?????????????????????      ? SQL + service?
                                     ?????????????????
                                     ?
                                     ?
                                     ?????????????????????
                                     ? errorHandler -> ?
                                     ? { message,      ?
                                     ? errors[] }      ?
                                     ?????????????????????

```

Layer	Responsibility	Can be bypassed?
Frontend validation	UX - early feedback, highlight fields	Yes (devtools, API tools)
Disabled submit button	UX - prevent accidental submit	Yes
Backend validation	Required - security & data integrity	No
Sanitization	Clean text before storage/search	No (in service/model path)
SQL parameterization	Prevent injection	No

Rule: Never rely on frontend or disabled buttons alone. Backend always returns structured errors on invalid input.

Standard API error response

```

{
  "success": false,
  "message": "Validation failed",
  "errors": [
    { "field": "email", "message": "Provider email is required" }
  ]
}

```

Frontend client (frontend/src/lib/auth/authApi.js):

```
throw new ApiRequestError(data.message, response.status, data.errors);
```

Shared frontend helpers (frontend/src/lib/apiErrorUtils.js):

Architecture flow: Frontend validates -> Backend validates -> Database (parameterized queries).

Function	Purpose
shouldShowSubmitError(message, fieldErrors)	Hide generic banner when field errors exist
getApiErrorMessage(error, fallback)	Prefer first field message over generic API text
applyApiFieldErrors(error, fieldMap)	Parse API error into field errors + banner
mergeApiFieldErrors(error, setFieldErrors)	Merge into React state; returns banner text

hasValidationErrors(validationErrors)

True when client validation object is non-empty

2. Current system status (summary)

Rating	Meaning
FULLY COVERED	Backend validates writes/queries; read-only or no forms
PARTIAL	Backend strong; frontend missing disable-on-invalid and/or errors[] field mapping
MISSING	Significant gap in frontend or backend for that module

Architecture flow: Frontend validates -> Backend validates -> Database (parameterized queries).

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Employees	Yes Strong	Yes Create/edit/suspend	Yes Create/edit/suspend	Yes Form modal + suspend modal
Orders	Yes Strong	Yes Main form + modals	Yes Main form + action modals	Yes Save + provider sync + modals
Invoices	Yes Strong	Yes Modals	Yes Create/X-ray/write-off	Yes Create + X-ray + write-off modals
Facilities	Yes Strong	Yes Create/edit/notes/docs	Yes Create/edit/notes/docs	Yes Main forms + note/upload modals
Providers	Partial Update only	Partial Via order page blur	N/A	Yes Order page maps sync errors
Payments	Yes Manual payment + list queries	Yes Basic	Yes Manual payment modal	Yes Manual payment modal
Settings	Yes Strong	Yes Profile/password	Yes Profile/password	Yes Profile/password
Notifications	Yes Query limit	N/A (read)	N/A	N/A
Reports	Yes Query parser	N/A (filters)	N/A	N/A
Stripe public	Yes Checkout	N/A	Partial Processing only	Yes publicPayApi.js
Activity log	Yes Service parse	N/A (read)	N/A	N/A
Dashboard	Yes Limit clamp	N/A (read)	N/A	N/A

Conclusion: Backend validation remains the authoritative gate on all major write paths. Frontend now uniformly disables submit when client validation fails and maps API errors[] to form fields on the primary write surfaces (orders, invoices, facilities, employees, settings, payments, and order action modals).

3. Shared backend infrastructure

Architecture flow: Frontend validates -> Backend validates -> Database (parameterized queries).

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File	Purpose
src/validators/validationHelpers.js	Email, ISO date, money, SSN, positive IDs, max length
src/validators/*.js	Per-domain request validators
src/lib/facilityValidation.js	Facility & doctor rules
src/lib/reportQueryParser.js	Report query validation + sanitization
src/utls/sanitize.js	stripControlCharacters, sanitizeText, sanitizeSearchText, escapeHtml
src/utls/sqlSafety.js	escapeLike, likeContains, assertPositiveInt, assertIsoDate
src/utls/fieldLimits.js	DB column-aligned max lengths

src/utls/serviceErrorUtils.js

rethrowServiceError, withTransaction, runNonCritical - shared service-layer error patterns

src/middleware/errorHandler.js

Global Express error middleware

```
src/middleware/uploadMiddleware.js
```

MIME allowlists, file size limits

src/app.js

```
express.json({ limit: "2mb" })
```

server.js

unhandledRejection, uncaughtException logging

Validator return shape

```
{ valid: boolean, errors?: [{ field: string, message: string }] }
```

Service-layer error handling

Architecture flow: Frontend validates -> Backend validates -> Database (parameterized queries).

Helper	Use when	Behavior
rethrowServiceError(error)	Transaction catch, DB helpers, email send failures	Preserves ApiError; maps MySQL/JWT/FS/Stripe via errorMapper
runNonCritical(label, fn, logger)	Side effects (notifications, activity logs, milestone rollups, payment emails)	Logs warning; returns null - parent request still succeeds
asyncHandler.runSafely(label, fn)	Background jobs (invoiceReminderJob, employeeReactivationJob)	Logs error; returns null - job loop continues

Controllers stay thin: no local try/catch; errors bubble to errorHandler.

4. Module reference (validation · sanitization · SQL · exceptions)

4.1 Auth - /api/auth

Area	Details
Validation	authValidator.js - login (trim + max length), 2FA, resend 2FA, refresh, logout
Sanitization	Trim on identifier; password max 128 chars; 2FA code digits-only
SQL injection	Parameterized queries in AuthSession, Employee
Frontend	login/page.jsx - validates, disables submit, maps API errors[] to email/password; TwoFactorAuthModal.jsx maps code errors

Exceptions handled

Type	Name / code	HTTP	Client message
Custom	ApiError	400/401	Invalid credentials, validation failed
JWT	TokenExpiredError	401	Session expired. Please sign in again.
JWT	JsonWebTokenError	401	Invalid or expired session. Please sign in again.
JWT	NotBeforeError	401	Invalid or expired session. Please sign in again.
MySQL	ER_DUP_ENTRY	409	This record already exists.
Network	ECONNREFUSED, etc.	503	Database is temporarily unavailable.

4.2 Employees - /api/employees

Area	Details
Validation	employeeValidator.js - create, update, suspend (future datetime)
Query	validateMilestoneStatsQuery - ISO from/to

Sanitization

sanitizeSearchText on list search

SQL injection

Employee - :named params, escapeLikePrefix

Frontend

EmployeeFormModal.jsx + SuspendEmployeeModal.jsx - validate, disable submit, map errors[]

Exceptions handled

Type	Name / code	HTTP	Client message
Custom	ApiError	400	Validation failed (field errors)
Custom	ApiError	400	You cannot suspend your own account
Custom	ApiError	400	Admin accounts cannot be suspended
Custom	ApiError	409	This email is already in use
Custom	ApiError	404	Employee not found
MySQL	ER_DUP_ENTRY	409	This record already exists.
MySQL	ER_DATA_TOO_LONG	400	One or more fields exceed the allowed length.

4.3 Orders - /api/orders

Area	Details
Validation	orderValidator.js - create/update, facility, notes, workflow; provider email required
Actions	orderActionValidator.js - cancel, mail, CNR, certificate, copy letter, pickup, fax, batch scan, medical scan, remove medical records, medical record file type
Query	validateOrderNotesQuery, validateSearchQuery
Sanitization	sanitizeSearchText on filters; sanitizeText on notes
SQL injection	Parameterized queries; sortDir whitelist; escaped LIKE
Upload	PDF medical records; batch scan; multer limits
Frontend	orders/new/page.jsx - validates, disables save, maps API errors[]; action modals (OrderFaxModal, OrderPickupModal, SendCopyLetterModal, SendInvoiceEmailModal, OrderNotesModal, OrderAddNoteModal, OrderNotesListModal, OrderCancelModal) use apiErrorUtils

Exceptions handled

Type	Name / code	HTTP	Client message
Custom	ApiError	400	Validation failed (e.g. provider email required)
Custom	ApiError	400	Cancellation reason is required
Custom	ApiError	400	At least one recipient email is required
Custom	ApiError	400	A valid company email is required
Custom	ApiError	400	Invalid record type
Custom	ApiError	400	Cannot cancel a deleted order
Custom	ApiError	404	Order not found
Upload	MulterError	400	File upload error / size limit
Upload	"Unsupported file type"	400	Unsupported file type
MySQL	ER_*	400/503	Mapped via errorMapper

4.4 Invoices - /api/invoices

Area

Details

Validation

invoiceValidator.js - create/update, X-ray, send/resend, write-off, email arrays

Sanitization

sanitizeTrimOrNull on text in service

SQL injection

Parameterized; report ORDER BY from internal constants

Frontend

CreateInvoiceModal.jsx, CreateXrayInvoiceModal.jsx, WriteOffInvoiceModal.jsx - validate, disable submit, map errors[]

Exceptions handled

Type	Name / code	HTTP	Client message
Custom	ApiError	400	Validation failed (amounts, dates, IDs)
Custom	ApiError	400	Invoice total must be greater than zero
Custom	ApiError	400	This invoice is already paid
Custom	ApiError	404	Invoice / order not found
MySQL	ER_DUP_ENTRY	409	This record already exists.

4.5 Facilities - /api/facilities

Area	Details
Validation	facilityValidator.js - create, update, resolve, resolve doctor, doctors, notes, document upload
Sanitization	sanitizeSearchText on search; sanitizeText on resolve-doctor name
SQL injection	escapeLikePrefix, parameterized queries
Upload	Document MIME/size limits
Frontend	facilities/new/page.jsx, facilities/[id]/info/page.jsx, FacilityAddNoteModal.jsx, UploadDocumentsModal.jsx - validate, disable submit, map errors[]

Exceptions handled

Type	Name / code	HTTP	Client message
Custom	ApiError	400	Validation failed (facility name, email, zip, etc.)
Custom	ApiError	400	Invalid document type
Custom	ApiError	400	A file is required
Custom	ApiError	404	Facility / doctor / note not found
Upload	MulterError	400	File size / upload error
MySQL	ER_ROW_IS_REFERENCED_2	400	This record is in use and cannot be removed.

4.6 Providers - /api/providers

Area	Details
Validation	providerValidator.js - update (name, email format, zip, phone)
Query	validateSearchQuery
Sanitization	sanitizeSearchText, stripControlCharacters on text fields
SQL injection	likeContains, assertPositiveInt on limit
Frontend	No dedicated provider form; order page syncProviderFromForm maps API validation errors to provider fields on blur

Exceptions handled

Type	Name / code	HTTP	Client message
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Custom

ApiError

400

Provider company name is required

Custom

ApiError

400

Validation failed (email, zip, phone)

Custom

ApiError

404

Provider not found

4.7 Payments - /api/payments

Area	Details
Validation	paymentValidator.js - manual payment; validatePaymentSearchQuery; validatePaymentListQuery (dates, orderId, limit 1-500)
Sanitization	sanitizeTrimOrNull on notes
SQL injection	Parameterized inserts/updates; list queries capped via parsePaymentListLimit
Frontend	ManualPaymentModal.jsx - validates, disables save when invalid, maps errors[] to check/date fields

Exceptions handled

Type	Name / code	HTTP	Client message
Custom	ApiError	400	orderId / check number / payment date required
Custom	ApiError	400	invoiceType must be regular or xray
Custom	ApiError	400	This invoice is already paid
Custom	ApiError	404	Order / invoice not found

4.8 Settings - /api/settings

Area	Details
Validation	settingsValidator.js - profile, password, notification booleans
Sanitization	Trim on profile fields
SQL injection	Parameterized Employee, EmployeeSettings
Frontend	Profile/password validate, disable save when invalid, map errors[]

Exceptions handled

Type	Name / code	HTTP	Client message
Custom	ApiError	400	Validation failed (firstName, email, password)
Custom	ApiError	400	Current password is incorrect
Custom	ApiError	409	This email is already in use
Custom	ApiError	404	User not found

4.9 Notifications - /api/notifications

Area	Details
Validation	validateNotificationQuery - limit 1-100
Sanitization	sanitizeSearchText on optional search
SQL injection	Parameterized Notification model
Frontend	Read-only list + mark read

Exceptions handled

Type	Name / code	HTTP	Client message
Custom	ApiError	404	Notification not found

4.10 Reports - /api/reports

Area	Details
Validation	reportQueryParser.js - dates, page size, cursor, enums
Sanitization	sanitizeSearchText on search fields
SQL injection	Bound parameters; whitelisted filters
Frontend	Filter UI only

Exceptions handled

Type	Name / code	HTTP	Client message
Custom	ApiError	400	Start date must be on or before end date
Custom	ApiError	400	Invalid cursor / companyGroupKey

4.11 Dashboard - /api/dashboard

Area	Details
Validation	limit clamped 1-20 in service
SQL injection	Static SQL + params
Frontend	Read-only widgets

Exceptions handled

Type	Name / code	HTTP	Client message
MySQL / Network	ER_, ECONN	400/503	Via errorMapper

4.12 Activity log - /api/activity-log

Area	Details
Validation	activityLogService.queryLogs - dates, module, pagination
Sanitization	sanitizeSearchText
SQL injection	escapeLike + parameterized
Frontend	Read-only table

Exceptions handled

Type	Name / code	HTTP	Client message
Custom	ApiError	403	Role-based access restrictions

4.13 Stripe public - /api/public/pay

Area	Details
Validation	stripeValidator.js - invoiceType; session_id on result; receipt download (sessionId + token)
Frontend	Pay page; publicPayApi.js throws ApiRequestError with errors[]

Exceptions handled

Type	Name / code	HTTP	Client message
Stripe	Stripe* types	4xx	Stripe error message
Custom	ApiError	400	invoiceType must be regular or xray
Custom	ApiError	400/410	Invalid / expired payment link
Custom	ApiError	400	Invoice amount must be greater than zero

4.14 Stripe webhook - /api/webhooks/stripe

Architecture flow: Frontend validates -> Backend validates -> Database (parameterized queries).

Area	Details
Validation	Webhook signature verification

4.15 Public record download - /api/public

Architecture flow: Frontend validates -> Backend validates -> Database (parameterized queries).

Area	Details
Validation	Token validation in recordDownloadService

5. Global exception catalog

5.1 Always returned to client (via errorHandler)

Category	Exact names	Typical HTTP
Custom	ApiError	400, 401, 403, 404, 409, 500, 503, 507
JSON parse	SyntaxError (entity.parse.failed)	400
Upload	MulterError, code LIMIT_FILE_SIZE	400
Upload	Error message "Unsupported file type"	400
JWT	TokenExpiredError, JsonWebTokenError, NotBeforeError	401
MySQL	ER_DUP_ENTRY	409
MySQL	ER_NO_REFERENCED_ROW_2, ER_ROW_IS_REFERENCED_2, ER_BAD_NULL_ERROR, ER_DATA_TOO_LONG, ER_TRUNCATED_WRONG_VALUE,	

ER_PARSE_ERROR

400

MySQL

ER_LOCK_WAIT_TIMEOUT,
ER_LOCK_DEADLOCK

MySQL

ER_ACCESS_DENIED_ERROR, other ER_*

Network

ECONNREFUSED, ECONNRESET, ETIMEDOUT,
EHOSTUNREACH, ENOTFOUND,
PROTOCOL_CONNECTION_LOST

File system

ENOENT, EACCES, EPERM, ENOSPC

Stripe

Any error.type starting with Stripe

4xx

Fallback

Unknown Error

500 - "Internal server error"

5.2 Server-only (never sent to client)

Event	Handler
unhandledRejection	server.js - logged
uncaughtException	server.js - logged
Non-critical side effects	runNonCritical / runSafely - logged as warning, request continues
Per-item batch failures	orderService.autoCreateOrdersFromBatch, invoiceReminderService - logged per item
Stack traces	Logged server-side only

6. SQL injection protection (global)

Technique	Implementation
Named parameters	All models: pool.execute(sql, { :param })
LIKE escaping	sqlSafety.escapeLike, likeContains, model escapeLikePrefix
LIMIT safety	assertPositiveInt, Math.min clamps
Sort whitelist	Order list: asc / desc only
Enum whitelist	Document types, record types, invoice types, report filters
No string concat	User input never embedded in SQL text

7. Data sanitization (global)

Architecture flow: Frontend validates -> Backend validates -> Database (parameterized queries).

Function	Purpose
stripControlCharacters	Remove null bytes / control chars
sanitizeText	Trim + max length
sanitizeSearchText	Search queries (max 200 chars default)
escapeHtml	Safe HTML in emails
isValidPersonName / isValidOrganizationName	Reject HTML markup and invalid characters in name fields
hasHtmlMarkup	Block < / > in free-text fields (notes, CNR reason, cancel reason)
fieldLimits.js	Matches DB column sizes

7.1 XSS / script injection (HTML output)

Surface	Risk	Mitigation
React UI (frontend/src)	Stored/reflected XSS via user fields	JSX escapes text by default; no dangerouslySetInnerHTML / innerHTML / eval in app code
Email HTML (emailService.js, views/emails/*)	Script tags in interpolated values	All interpolated HTML values use escapeHtml; multiline text uses escapeHtmlMultiline
API write validators	Script/HTML stored in notes, addresses, search,	

invoices

addNoHtmlMarkupError on free-text fields;

person/org name patterns on name fields

Storage (sanitizeText)

Bypassed validation / legacy data paths

stripHtmlMarkup removes < and > before persistence

API JSON responses

Low (consumed by React, not executed as HTML)

Content-Type: application/json; security headers on
API

Uploaded files

MIME sniffing

Upload middleware whitelists MIME types;
X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff on API and Next.js

Headers (v1.6): X-Content-Type-Options, X-Frame-Options, Referrer-Policy on Express (app.js) and Next.js (next.config.ts).

Name validation (v1.7): Person names allow letters, spaces, -, ', . only. Organization names allow letters, digits, and &.,'()#-/. Enforced in backend validators and matching frontend forms.

System-wide text validation (v1.8): All notes, reasons, descriptions, addresses, memos, and search queries reject angle brackets at validation time. Frontend mirrors the same rules on order, facility, invoice, payment, fax, pickup, and reminder forms.

8. Frontend validation utilities (complete coverage v1.3)

Shared module: frontend/src/lib/apiErrorUtils.js

Architecture flow: Frontend validates -> Backend validates -> Database (parameterized queries).

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TwoFactorAuthModal.jsx	Yes (6-digit code)	Yes (code)
EmployeeFormModal.jsx	Yes	Yes
SuspendEmployeeModal.jsx	Yes	Yes (reactivatedDate)
orders/new/page.jsx	Yes	Yes (save + provider sync)
OrderAddNoteModal.jsx	Yes	Yes
OrderNotesModal.jsx	Yes	Yes
OrderNotesListModal.jsx	Yes	Yes
OrderCancelModal.jsx	Yes	Yes (reason)
OrderFaxModal.jsx	Yes	Yes
OrderPickupModal.jsx	Yes	Yes
SendCopyLetterModal.jsx	Yes	Yes
SendInvoiceEmailModal.jsx	Yes	Yes
facilities/new/page.jsx	Yes	Yes
facilities/[FacilityId]/info/page.jsx	Yes	Yes
FacilityAddNoteModal.jsx	Yes	Yes (note)
UploadDocumentsModal.jsx	Yes	Yes (file)
settings/page.jsx	Yes	Yes
ManualPaymentModal.jsx	Yes	Yes
CreateInvoiceModal.jsx	Yes	Yes
CreateXrayInvoiceModal.jsx	Yes	Yes
WriteOffInvoiceModal.jsx	Yes	Yes (amount, orderAction)
publicPayApi.js	N/A	Yes (ApiRequestError)

Status: All identified write surfaces now follow the standard pattern - client validation, disabled submit when invalid, and API field error mapping.

9. Validator file index

File	Modules
authValidator.js	Auth
employeeValidator.js	Employees

orderValidator.js

Orders (create/update)

orderActionValidator.js

Order actions

invoiceValidator.js

Invoices

facilityValidator.js

Facilities, notes, documents

providerValidator.js

Providers

paymentValidator.js

Payments

settingsValidator.js

Settings

queryValidators.js

Notifications, order notes, search, payments, payment lists, route id, Stripe result, milestones

stripeValidator.js

Stripe checkout, receipt download

validationHelpers.js

Shared primitives

reportQueryParser.js

Reports

facilityValidation.js

Facility/doctor rules (lib)

10. Testing checklist

Architecture flow: Frontend validates -> Backend validates -> Database (parameterized queries).

11. Complete backend module checklist (v1.5)

Every API route group and how validation, sanitization, and SQL safety are applied.

Module	Routes prefix	Validation	Sanitization	SQL injection
Auth	/api/auth	authValidator.js (all POST)	Trim identifier; password max length	Employee, AuthSession - :named params
Employees	/api/employees	employeeValidator.js (create/update/suspend); validateMilestoneStatsQuery	sanitizeSearchText on list	escapeLikePrefix, parameterized
Orders	/api/orders	orderValidator.js, orderActionValidator.js, validateSearchQuery, validateOrderNotesQuery	sanitizeText/sanitizeSearchText; buildOrderDbPayload	Whitelist sort; likeContains; parameterized
Invoices	/api/invoices	invoiceValidator.js (writes)	sanitizeTrimOrNull	reportQueryParser; internal ORDER BY
Facilities	/api/facilities	facilityValidator.js incl. resolve doctor; validateSearchQuery	sanitizeSearchText, sanitizeText on doctor resolve	escapeLikePrefix; parameterized
Providers	/api/providers	providerValidator.js (update); validateSearchQuery	sanitizeSearchText, stripControlCharacters	likeContains; assertPositiveInt
Payments	/api/payments	paymentValidator.js, validatePaymentSearchQuery, validatePaymentListQuery	sanitizeTrimOrNull on notes	Parameterized; limit 1-500 on lists
Settings	/api/settings	settingsValidator.js	Trim profile fields	Parameterized Employee, EmployeeSettings
Notifications	/api/notifications	validateNotificationQuery	sanitizeSearchText	Parameterized Notification
Reports	/api/reports	reportQueryParser.js	sanitizeSearchText on all search fields	Bound params; enum whitelists
Dashboard	/api/dashboard	Service clamps limit 1-20	N/A (aggregates)	Static SQL + numeric LIMIT
Activity log	/api/activity-log	activityLogService.queryLogs	sanitizeSearchText	escapeLike; parameterized
Stripe public	/api/public/pay	stripeValidator.js, validateStripeCheckoutResult, validateStripeReceiptDownload	Token trim in service	Parameterized token/session lookups
Stripe webhook	/api/webhooks/stripe	Signature verification	N/A	Parameterized Stripe DB ops
Public download	/api/public/records-download	recordDownloadService token check	Token trim	Parameterized :token
Health	/health	N/A	N/A	No DB

Shared query helpers (queryValidators.js)

Function	Used for
validateNotificationQuery	Notification list limit
validateOrderNotesQuery	Order notes pagination/dates
validateMilestoneStatsQuery	Employee milestone ISO dates
validateSearchQuery	Facility/provider/doctor search (q max 200)
validatePaymentSearchQuery	Payment order invoice search
validatePaymentListQuery	Manual/online payment lists (orderId, dates, limit)
validatePositiveIntRouteParam	Route :id positive integer
validateStripeCheckoutResult	Stripe result session_id
parsePaymentListLimit	Clamp list results (default 100, max 500)

SQL injection rules (all modules)

- 1. Never concatenate user input into SQL strings.
- 2. Always use pool.execute(sql, { :param }) with namedPlaceholders: true.
- 3. LIKE searches: escapeLike, likeContains, or model escapeLikePrefix.
- 4. LIMIT/OFFSET: numeric coercion + Math.min clamp or parsePaymentListLimit.
- 5. ORDER BY / sort: whitelist (asc/desc) or internal column constants only.
- 6. Enums: assertEnum or Set membership before SQL.

DMS Project - Internal technical reference